IOWN

The Morning Brief

APRIL 19, 2026

Open and Shut

Weekend Edition — Iran reversed Friday's Hormuz opening within hours, firing on ships Saturday, even as a $20 billion nuclear framework takes shape behind the scenes.

S&P FUTURES (SUN)	BRENT CRUDE FRI CLOSE	GOLD FRI CLOSE	HORMUZ	FEAR & GREED
~7,159 ↑0.5%	~$90 · Re-closure not yet priced	~$4,860 · 4th weekly gain	Re-closed Sat · IRGC fired on ships	21 · Extreme Fear

SECTION 01

Markets — Weekend Edition

FUTURES GREEN — BUT THE HORMUZ REVERSAL HAS NOT HIT OIL YET

S&P 500 futures are trading at approximately 7,159 in thin Sunday evening activity, up roughly 0.5% from Friday's record close of 7,126. However, the most consequential weekend development has not yet been priced into energy markets: Iran reversed Friday's Hormuz opening on Saturday, with the IRGC firing on at least two commercial vessels and declaring the Strait closed until the US lifts its naval blockade, according to Axios, PBS, and Al Jazeera. Oil markets are closed on weekends, meaning Brent crude's Friday close of approximately $90 — which reflected a roughly 9% decline on the initial opening announcement — does not account for the reversal. Monday's oil open could be volatile. The equity market faces a compressed test: record highs, a ceasefire expiring Wednesday, and a Hormuz situation that deteriorated materially over the weekend.

S&P FUTURES	~7,159 · ↑0.5% from Fri close
BRENT CRUDE	~$90 Fri close · Re-closure NOT priced
GOLD	~$4,860 · 4th consecutive weekly gain
BITCOIN (LIVE)	~$76,000 · Weekend bid despite re-closure
CEASEFIRE	Expires Wed April 22 · 3 trading days

WARSH HEARING TUESDAY — THE FED TRANSITION BEGINS

Kevin Warsh's confirmation hearing before the Senate Banking Committee is scheduled for Tuesday at 10 AM ET, according to Bloomberg and CNBC. His financial disclosures reveal assets between $131 million and $209 million — news reports note this would make him the wealthiest Fed Chair in the institution's history if confirmed. The substantive question is whether Warsh signals continuity with Powell's rate path or previews a different stance aligned with the war-driven inflation backdrop. Senator Tillis's refusal to vote until the DOJ drops its investigation into Chair Powell remains a procedural obstacle, though Committee Chairman Tim Scott has scheduled the hearing regardless. Powell's term expires May 15, and the market has not yet begun pricing leadership transition risk into rate expectations.

Friday's Hormuz opening lasted less than 24 hours. Iran fired on ships Saturday. Oil has not repriced. The ceasefire expires in three days. And futures are green at all-time highs. The market is pricing the deal, not the guns — but Monday's oil open could test that conviction. **Think Like an Owner.**

Geopolitics

HORMUZ REVERSED — 24 HOURS FROM OPEN TO GUNFIRE

Iran's declaration that the Strait of Hormuz was open to all commercial shipping lasted approximately 24 hours. On Saturday, the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps reversed course, firing on at least two commercial vessels — including an Indian-flagged VLCC — and declaring the Strait closed until the US lifts its naval blockade, according to Axios and PBS. The IRGC warned that any vessel movement from anchorage in the Persian Gulf and Sea of Oman would be considered hostile. The reversal was a direct response to President Trump's statement that the US blockade would remain in full force, which Tehran interpreted as negating the practical effect of Friday's opening. For energy markets, the 24-hour sequence — open, ships transit, re-close, fire on ships — creates a potentially volatile Monday: Brent settled at approximately $90 on Friday's roughly 9% decline, but the re-closure could drive a partial reversal of that move. IOWN's energy sleeve (CVX, VLO, OKE) may see renewed strength if oil reprices the deterioration.

THE $20 BILLION NUCLEAR FRAMEWORK — DIPLOMACY BEHIND THE GUNFIRE

Behind the military escalation, a diplomatic framework is taking shape. Axios reported Friday that the US is considering releasing $20 billion in frozen Iranian assets in exchange for Iran surrendering its entire enriched uranium stockpile, including approximately 450 kilograms enriched to 60% purity. The proposal represents a compromise between earlier positions — Washington had initially offered $6 billion for restricted humanitarian use, while Tehran sought access to $27 billion. The critical sticking point, according to CNN and Axios, is the duration of an enrichment moratorium: the US is pushing for a 20-year suspension, while Iran has countered with five years. For IOWN, a completed deal could be structurally deflationary for energy (compressing the war premium in CVX, VLO, and OKE), constructive for growth and digital assets (AMD, NVDA, COIN, IBIT), and catalytic for rate cut expectations if the war premium embedded in inflation data begins to fade. The tension between Saturday's military escalation and the emerging economic framework is the defining dynamic heading into the ceasefire deadline.

ISLAMABAD ROUND 2 — THREE DAYS TO NARROW THE GAP

Pakistani mediators are actively working to convene a second round of direct US-Iran talks before Wednesday's ceasefire expiry, according to Al Jazeera and PBS. A delegation led by Army Chief General Asim Munir and Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi traveled to Tehran this week to deliver a US message aimed at narrowing gaps. The first round in Islamabad on April 11–12 lasted 21 hours across three sessions but ended without agreement, with Vice President Vance citing Iran's refusal to accept US terms on nuclear commitments. The Franco-British military planning summit at the UK's Permanent Joint Headquarters in Northwood is also scheduled for this week, following Friday's Paris summit of approximately 50 nations. However, Saturday's re-closure complicates the diplomatic picture: Iran's willingness to fire on ships even during the ceasefire period suggests its patience with the US blockade has a shorter fuse than the two-week ceasefire window implied. If Round 2 does not produce at least a framework for extension, the ceasefire could lapse with Hormuz actively contested — a materially different risk environment than the one equities priced on Friday.

HORMUZ	Re-closed Saturday · IRGC fired on ships
NUCLEAR FRAMEWORK	$20B frozen funds for uranium stockpile
ENRICHMENT GAP	US: 20-year moratorium · Iran: 5 years
ISLAMABAD ROUND 2	Pakistan mediating · Talks before Wed expiry
CEASEFIRE	Expires Wed April 22 · No formal extension

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Monday's Oil Open Is the Week's First Test. Iran's Saturday re-closure means Brent crude's Friday close of approximately $90 may not hold. Oil markets open to a fundamentally different Hormuz picture than the one that drove Friday's roughly 9% decline. If Brent rebounds sharply, the energy risk premium re-establishes itself and the post-conflict equity thesis faces its first substantive challenge at all-time highs. IOWN's energy sleeve (CVX, VLO, OKE) is positioned on the right side of this trade; the growth sleeve may face headwinds from a risk premium expansion. Carson's SPY $645.80 retracement target remains the only active level — approximately 9% below Friday's close and relevant only under a material re-escalation scenario. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. Warsh, GPC, and the Ceasefire — Three Catalysts in Three Days. The ceasefire expires Wednesday. Warsh faces the Senate Banking Committee Tuesday at 10 AM ET, where the Tillis standoff over the Powell DOJ investigation could complicate the confirmation timeline. IOWN dividend sleeve holding GPC reports Q1 earnings Tuesday (consensus $1.82 EPS), and Tesla reports Wednesday. The Northwood military planning summit — the follow-up to Friday's Paris summit — is also scheduled for this week and could influence the Hormuz trajectory by establishing a credible mine clearance and escort framework. *Think Like an Owner.*

3. Digital Assets Firm Despite Hormuz Reversal. Bitcoin has appreciated to approximately $76,000 over the weekend despite the Hormuz re-closure, suggesting the 24/7 market is weighting the diplomatic framework — the $20 billion deal, Islamabad Round 2 — more heavily than Saturday's military escalation. The weekend bid in digital assets has been a useful leading indicator throughout the conflict. IOWN's digital sleeve (IBIT, ETHA, COIN, MARA, HUT, HOOD) continues to benefit from both the risk-on trade and the structural tailwind from the SEC's pattern day trading rule elimination. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

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